



Ping Pong in Space!

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stigma. If I understand the Indian gamers and Indian parents' mentality, then there might be half a dozen categories that are critically important to make an amazing AppStore or content store. So I just need to work hard on them and we can do very good job on them because we are focussing on those verticals, just like Myntra can do an amazing job in apparels then let's say Amazon may not be to do. It's exactly the same thing we can do like Myntra's job in apparels that horizontals cannot do.

4 Despite making it easy to accept payments, do Indian customers pay? Because we've been talking to developers for quite a while now and the general consensus about this region is that people want free stuff, and most of the revenue is generated by serving ads. So how do you see a paid platform faring under such circumstances?

Badri: Yes, the Indian customer pays a lot of money. No developer makes much money nonetheless. So today if you look at a typical app, we are not having too many apps on Google Play, but whatever apps we are seeing, the average revenue of per install of Google Play on an average

might realise that they have got about 100 million shoppers with credit cards on file and decide to open up a Google like API where they will make one-step transactions, then we will use Flipkart's API or the payment ecosystem in India will undergo change where credit card transactions below 100 rupees wouldn't need a 2-factor authentication and we could simply start using credit cards and the consumer doesn't have to jump through 3 hoops while shopping. The payment ecosystem is evolving and we will try everything. Today it happens at the operator level within India since we have the largest wallet user base in India with 900 million people having wallets.

4 How do you make your platform more appealing to developers as well as users?

Badri: Modernization, discovery and distribution. But we aren't only on gaming, try video, for example, let's take one video player and call it Rajshri entertainments. Let's take the example of Rajshri channel for YouTube which is run by Rajat. He is the number 5 YouTuber and number 10 YouTube channel in India. But Rajat doesn't say YouTube is my sole game,

done this for as long as we can remember. Even the JAVA developers of the games till 2011-12 put their content on OVI, GetJar, SlideME and everything else. Because they understood that every channel mattered. And I think that other platforms like ours are just coming to scale now. The reason is our ecosystem is just three years old and you know that the Nokia ecosystem lived for about 25 years. So we are too young and I think it's only a matter of time before developers say, "Today I uploaded on Google Play, and now let's upload on 1,2,3,4 platforms ... that's it. So developers will come to us as long as we create many success stories. And we are working on creating those success stories. I will give an example of those success stories, UCBrowser were one of those amazing success stories and we have spoken about it in our PR releases. We had delivered about 20 million downloads. We have done success stories with game developers called HeroCraft for whom we have delivered 10-15 million downloads. For another video app called VidMate, we had delivered about 5 million downloads.

4 We heard, you'd started a new initiative at NASSCOM GDC to attract gamers. How is that program coming along?

Badri: We were at the NASSCOM GDC this year working with developers there creating success stories saying, "Hey listen, you can make money from us which is outside of Google Play". And three developers took anywhere from ₹2 lakhs to ₹4 lakhs in the developers' conference. The money is not that much, I am not cutting them a cheque of 2 crores, it's still 2-4 lakhs which they didn't have. This might have been the money they would have made from Google Play or maybe even a little bit less and that's ok. After the launch of GamesBond we made a big splash at GDC (Game Developer Conference), we were all over the place. We gave out 6 awards this year and we sponsored both NASSCOM's and our own awards. So we actually gave out most of the monetization to game developers and that's what we are working on, convincing developers that we are an emerging platform and we are an interesting site that's not to be ignored. **4**

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game is probably less than 50 cents. So that's why there is a mad race on Google Play to get the most number of downloads, because the revenue on downloads is ridiculously low. 50 cents happens to be on the higher side, when you look at apps with the most number of downloads it's probably around 15 - 10 cents, if they are lucky. So it's terribly bad and on Google Play the payment mechanism has not really worked well, so in fact Google is also doing operator billing, which you know already. So to that extent operator billing is just a wallet and don't think of it more than that. And if tomorrow, Paytm scales we might use Paytm or other service like FreeCharge if they scale. Maybe one day companies like Flipkart

Rajat distributes his content across 150 different stores around the world. So it's actually on the owner of the content to go out there once he's made a piece of content like his videos. The life of a video is incredibly short, maybe a month. And the life of a game is very short, maybe 6 months. But the effort in making the game and getting it out there through distribution channels is pretty dramatic. For example, on Google Play now, you will see five Chhota Bheem games right now on the homepage. Check after 6 months and none of them would be there. So these 6 months are all the developer has. How does he make the most money out of his content? The answer is blindingly obvious. And movies and videos have